

BOARD UPDATE • Q2 2026

# Meridian Freight

The quarter beat plan, but a carrier-capacity squeeze needs a board decision today.



# **We beat plan on revenue and margin — and we need your call on capacity by Friday.**

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Bottom line up front: Q2 revenue landed 11% ahead of plan and contribution margin expanded for the third straight quarter. The one open question is carrier capacity for peak season, and it requires board approval this week.

- Strong quarter, clean balance sheet, no surprises in the numbers.
- One time-boxed decision: pre-buy capacity now, or risk Q4 service levels.



# Revenue, margin, and cash all came in ahead of plan.

\$58.4M

Quarterly revenue

PLAN \$52.6M • +11% **AHEAD** BOARD



31%

Contribution margin

+3PP QOQ **AHEAD** AUDIT

\$41M

Cash & equivalents

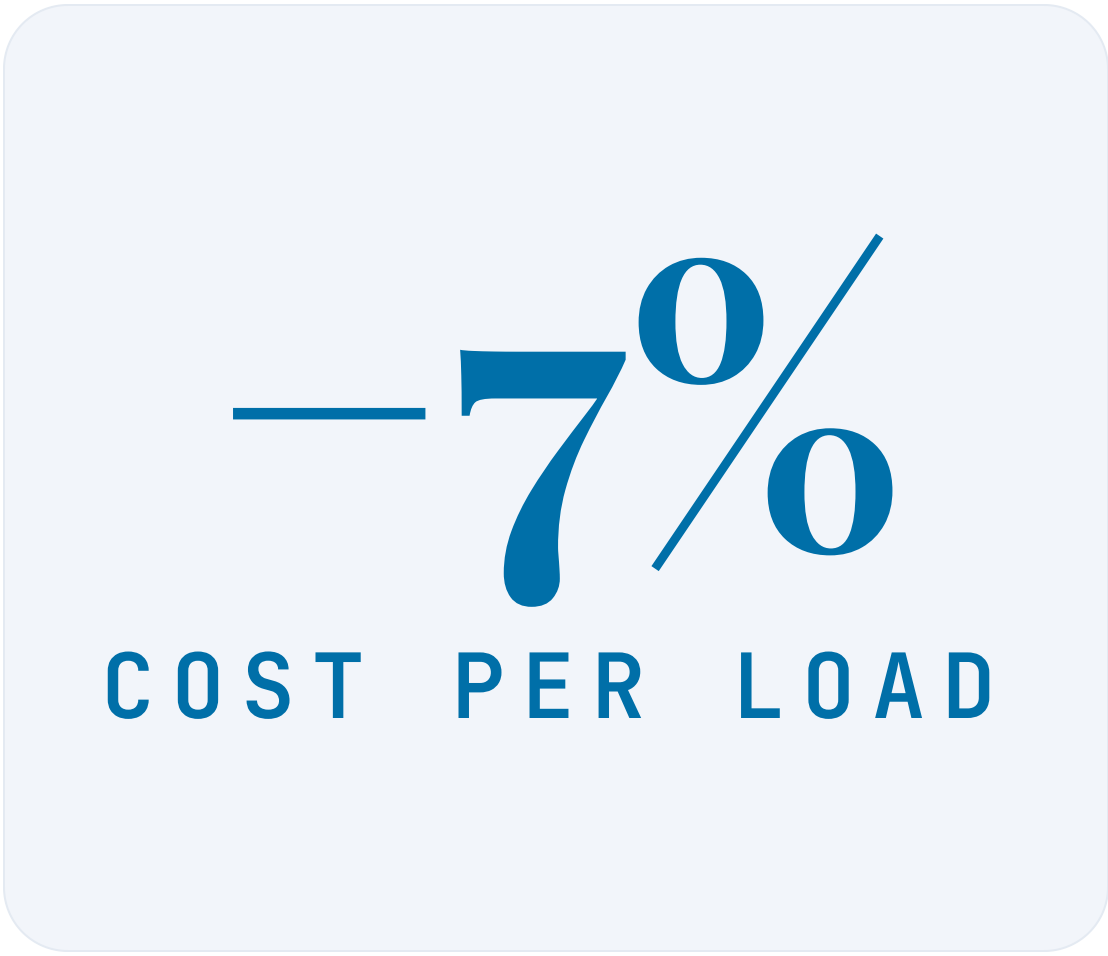
+\$6M QOQ **ON PLAN** INVESTOR



DEMAND • Q2 2026

# Growth was broad — every region and lane category pulled its weight.

*Measured against Q2 2025, same lane mix, normalized for fuel surcharge.*





# Demand is outrunning the carrier capacity we have contracted.

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Volume is up 18% year over year, but our committed carrier capacity grew only 9%.

Through Q2 we covered the gap on the spot market — fine in a soft rate environment, but peak season changes that math.

- Spot exposure was 14% of loads in Q2, up from 6% a year ago.
- Spot rates historically spike 30–40% from October through December.



THE EXPOSURE WE ARE CARRYING INTO PEAK

**\$4.2M**

of incremental Q4 cost if we cover peak  
demand on the spot market at last  
year's rate curve.



# A capacity pre-buy locks rates now, before the peak-season run-up.

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Carriers will commit Q4 capacity at today's rates in exchange for a guaranteed minimum. Signing in June secures the lanes we need at roughly 22% below the spot curve we'd otherwise pay in Q4.

- The commitment is \$9.8M of guaranteed spend across four core carriers.
- Break-even holds even if peak volume comes in 15% below forecast.



# The pre-buy is the only option that protects both service and margin.

## **Protects service • Hurts margin.**

Cover peak entirely on the spot market

## **Hurts service • Hurts margin.**

Cap volume to contracted capacity, turn away demand

## **Hurts service • Protects margin.**

Defer the decision to Q3 and renegotiate

## **Protects service • Protects margin.**

Pre-buy Q4 capacity now at locked rates



# The pre-buy pays for itself even in a soft-demand scenario.





# Full-year guidance holds, with upside if peak demand lands as forecast.

\$238M

FY revenue guide

REAFFIRMED **ON PLAN** BOARD



30%

FY contribution margin

+2PP VS FY25 **ON PLAN** AUDIT

99%

peak coverage with pre-buy

VS 86% WITHOUT **DECISION** OPS



# We ask the board to approve a \$9.8M Q4 capacity pre-buy this week.

APPROVE THE PRE-BUY

Locks peak rates 22% below spot and protects our 96% on-time record.

DEFER TO Q3

Cedes the rate window; exposes Q4 to a projected \$4.2M spot premium.



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Strong quarter —  
let's protect the peak.